MeritLense Assessment Governance and Decision Rulebook

Implementation direction for AI led and employer led assessments

Owner: MeritLense OÜ | Issued by: Ahmed Bashir | Version 1.0 | 20 October 2026

Purpose and execution authority

Use this document to consolidate the existing rules, correct the discrepancies reported on 18–19 October, and implement the agreed scheduled-assessment improvements. Reuse the current infrastructure and consolidated 2,100-question bank. Do not restart the bank audit or split the 441 retained questions into a separate product.

Proceed with implementation, testing and controlled release through the existing engineering process. No additional routine management approval checkpoint is introduced by this document. Escalate only a genuinely unresolved methodological decision or material conflict, with the affected rule IDs, evidence and a recommended resolution. This direction is not a claim that the current implementation has passed validation.

Product principles

GOV-01: AI Assists. Rules Decide. Employers Decide. AI extracts or organizes evidence. Deterministic rules calculate applicable outcomes. The employer makes the hiring decision.

GOV-02: AI-led and employer-led assessments are distinct. Preserve their source labels, evidence and calculation rules. Do not claim the two paths are equivalent without validation.

GOV-03: Apply the same approved decision logic across B2B and B2C for the same assessment path, role and tier. Account permissions and package entitlements may differ; account type alone must not change competence scoring.

GOV-04: Store completion status, evidence validity, readiness, review status and certificate eligibility separately. A valid failed assessment is a delivered service, not a platform failure.

Rule precedence and completeness

GOV-05: Use the approved, versioned question specification and applicable role/path rules. Current code behavior and AI-drafted classifications are not proof of policy approval. Record contradictions instead of inventing precedence.

GOV-06: Every selectable question must have executable full, partial and zero conditions where applicable, an approved maximum, omission consequences and safety mapping. An undefined rubric is a configuration defect to resolve before selecting that question, not a reason to send each candidate to human review. Use a validated equivalent question within the same role, competency, tier and language path where available; otherwise show an availability exception. Never silently reduce required coverage.

1 Assessment paths and multilingual interview

AI led assessment

AI-01: Select exactly 21 questions for Full and 7 for Screening using the approved role-specific allocation and Critical Competency coverage. Preserve canonical competency codes, IDs and applicability. No cross-role fallback or silent substitution of a different candidate-facing language.

AI-02: Present the approved question in the selected language. Accept supported voice or typed answers, retain the captured original, and record answer status. AI identifies covered, missing, contradicted and uncertain indicators with supporting text; it does not assign final scores.

AI-03: Score practical knowledge demonstrated by the answer. Do not claim practical observation merely because a question says “demonstrate”. Record an observed task only when it was actually observed through an appropriate assessment path.

Employer led scheduled assessment

SCH-01: The employer or authorized evaluator conducts the interview and supplies the ratings. Suggested questions may come from the bank; employer-authored equivalent questions are allowed. Require coverage of applicable role criteria, not an obligatory bank sequence or an independent evaluator.

SCH-02: Display the role criteria and criteria still not assessed. Link each rating to an answer reference or a concise evaluator observation. A coverage indicator confirms that evidence was recorded; it does not establish that any custom question is professionally valid. Do not advertise automatic question validation as an existing feature.

SCH-03: Use the structured scorecard described in section 3. No routine second reviewer or MeritLense approval is required. The employer’s rating remains attributed to the employer.

Existing voice and text translation

LAN-01: Preserve the already implemented bidirectional translation. Each participant may speak in their own language and receive the other party’s translated speech and readable text. Each may also type in their own language and receive translated text. Do not replace this with an English-only interview.

LAN-02: Keep the captured original, translated text, speaker, language, sequence and available timestamps linked. Display original versus translation clearly. Only claim stored audio/video if actually retained. A transcript is captured speech rendered as text; a translation is a separate rendering, not the original words.

LAN-03: English and Arabic are canonical assessment languages. Other supported languages use the actual approved translation routes. Preserve question identity and rubric identity across translation. Correct equivalent meanings must receive equivalent treatment; accent or polished wording alone must not change a competence score.

LAN-04: AI can propose evidence links or identify missing coverage. It must not fabricate evidence, coach a candidate toward the correct answer, or overwrite evaluator ratings. A technical clarification or retry must preserve the question’s assessment intent.

2 AI question scoring and calculation

Rule	Required behavior
SCR-01 Full credit	Award 5 only when the question-specific full-credit conditions are satisfied, including applicable mandatory and safety requirements.
SCR-02 Partial credit	Award 3 where the question-specific partial-credit rule permits it. Do not infer the band solely from the number of missing items unless that is the approved rubric.
SCR-03 Zero	Apply the approved zero-score conditions to wrong, insufficient or explicitly unsafe evidence. Confirmed voluntary skipping or an intentionally blank submitted answer is zero and retains its maximum in the denominator.
SCR-04 Evidence loss	Technical absence or unreliable processing is not an incorrect answer. Retry or recapture; if unresolved, record insufficient evidence without inventing a zero.
SCR-05 Legacy	Retain the 70 exceptions: 66 questions use 0/5, one uses 0/2/3, and three use completion percentage. Execute their actual approved specifications; do not force them into 5/3/0.

SCR-06: A missing ordinary indicator, a failed mandatory condition, a zero score and a critical safety failure are distinct. Their consequences follow explicit rules. Do not make every Must Include mandatory by default. Do not silently treat a missing statement as an affirmative unsafe action.

SCR-07: Interpret negative evidence in context. Negated unsafe actions, quotations, other-person descriptions and corrected hypotheticals are not automatically affirmed candidate intentions. Each approved negative indicator needs severity and score/gate consequences. A Critical Competency classification alone does not make every weak answer an unsafe act.

SCR-08: Resolve an undefined “two or more omissions” case in the question specification before activation. There is no newly approved universal half-the-indicators rule. Do not route routine partial answers to administrators.

Arithmetic and incomplete evidence

CAL-01: Overall percentage = total applicable earned points / total maximum points of assigned questions × 100. For 21 questions all worth 5, the maximum is 105; for 7 such questions, 35. Legacy maxima can change these totals. Example: 12×5 + 6×3 + 3×0 = 78; 78/105 = 74.29%.

CAL-02: Compute competency scores from their applicable assigned questions under the approved aggregation. Preserve the current approved aggregation and weights; do not introduce equal competency weighting or alter weights merely to fit a maximum. Negative or zero weights require a documented scoring purpose, not an importer balancing shortcut.

CAL-03: Reconcile every assigned question to a response state. Missing response rows must not disappear unnoticed. Candidate abandonment is non-completion; it is not a fully completed zero-score assessment. Apply zero to confirmed skips without representing abandonment as completion.

CAL-04: If platform evidence is unresolved, retain the assigned maximum and evidence-coverage counts, but do not publish a final overall percentage as though all evidence was assessed. If shown, any available-evidence percentage must be explicitly provisional and use a labelled subtotal. Never show 103/103 as a completed final 100% when an assigned answer is unavailable.

3 Structured employer scorecard and readiness

Scorecard operation

SCH-04: For each applicable criterion, show a plain-language performance description and allow one level selection. Require a short evidence note or linked answer/observation. Include Not Assessed / Insufficient Evidence as a separate option; it has no invented numerical value.

SCH-05: Reuse existing approved rating anchors and their numeric mapping where documented. The agreed improvement is level selection mapped deterministically to a fixed score, not a free number within a broad range. The precise level-to-point values have not been supplied in the management discussion; do not invent midpoints or present them as approved. Retain the current documented rating mechanism until that specific mapping is resolved, and isolate the affected enhancement rather than changing unrelated scoring.

SCH-06: Behavioral Indicators remains a canonical competency with its applicable approved calculation. Do not downgrade it to a non-scoring note by implication. Consistency must retain its documented meaning, direction and scoring role; do not add or average it as a percentage without an explicit mapping. Flag a missing mapping once as a configuration decision.

SCH-07: Ratings are editable in draft. Validate required evidence and applicable criteria on submission. Lock final ratings and record evaluator identity, time and rule version. AI findings may support review but cannot overwrite the employer's submitted outcome through a later background job.

Readiness boundaries and gates

OUT-01: The existing score-label boundaries are retained: 60% and above = Ready; 40% to below 60% = Partially Ready; below 40% = Not Ready. Evaluate exact stored values before display rounding. These numerical labels are subject to the applicable path's approved competency and safety gates; they do not replace them.

OUT-02: For AI-led assessments, retain approved role-profile checks and Critical/Non-Critical competency consequences. The rulebook draft reports a 60% competency threshold; verify its versioned configuration rather than replacing question-specific thresholds or readiness logic with the overall-score boundary.

OUT-03: An applicable confirmed critical failure prevents Ready and invokes its approved outcome, including Not Ready where specified. A missing required Critical evidence item cannot be silently treated as passed. Distinguish insufficient coverage from demonstrated failure.

OUT-04: Employer-led outcomes use evaluator evidence and the rules for that path. A high average must not bypass an applicable approved safety gate. Do not copy AI question gates blindly onto custom interview ratings, or claim that the same person must obtain identical outcomes in both paths.

OUT-05: Completion and evidence status are separate from readiness. Incomplete describes an unfinished session; Insufficient Evidence describes inadequate reliable evidence. Display the actual cause and next action rather than disguising either as a poor-performance result.

OUT-06: Use stable internal status codes. Display Ready / Partially Ready / Not Ready as جاهز / جاهز جزئيًا / غير جاهز in Arabic. Use the session/output language consistently. Helpful explanatory wording may accompany a label but must not change the underlying classification.

4 Outputs certificates and corrections

Automatic result delivery

DOC-01: Automatically deliver valid results and applicable reports. Low scores, confirmed failure, or certificate ineligibility must not independently create a routine release hold. A certificate-only problem must not block a valid report or captured transcript.

DOC-02: Use consistent document names: Interview Transcript, Assessment Analysis Report and Readiness Certificate. Offer View and Download for available authorized outputs. For employer-led sessions without captured dialogue, provide an Assessment Summary rather than a fabricated transcript.

DOC-03: The report must identify role, path, tier, language, evaluator where applicable, question/rule versions, completion and evidence coverage, competency results, readiness reasons, relevant safety findings and output eligibility. Separate unassessed criteria from failed criteria. Map each risk to the correct competency.

DOC-04: A competency affected by a critical failure must not appear unqualifiedly Passed or “no risk”. Explain any difference between raw points, effective scoring and gate consequences. Do not market raw 100% as overall successful performance when a critical gate has failed.

DOC-05: Report only what was measured. No claims of recorded audio, practical observation, cognitive testing or suitability for another role without the relevant assessment evidence. Mark employer-led results explicitly as Employer-Led / Evaluator-Rated; do not present them as an independent AI assessment.

Certificate eligibility

CER-01: Retain the existing approved certificate policy for each path. Management has confirmed that readiness thresholds and certificate conditions already exist. Document the actual gate configuration; do not invent a new universal checklist from current code or the draft alone.

CER-02: A percentage at or above 60 is not sufficient by itself: applicable completion, consent, identity, evidence and safety requirements still govern. Screening does not issue a readiness certificate. Not Ready must not receive a certificate that represents readiness; a completion record, if offered, must be clearly different.

CER-03: Preserve the existing approved treatment of Partially Ready certificates where applicable; do not infer a new entitlement or blanket prohibition. Any document issued for this status must accurately state it. Employer-led documents identify the source of evaluation.

Authorized corrections

AUD-01: Administrators may correct verified capture/interpretation errors or process authorized evaluator corrections. Record the original, replacement, reason, actor and timestamp. Correcting evidence is not permission to improve what the candidate actually said.

AUD-02: Re-extract and recalculate through the applicable versioned engine after correction. Preserve original evidence, scoring runs, evaluator and documents. No unrestricted manual readiness selection.

AUD-03: Produce a new output version. Mark previous documents superseded or revoked where appropriate and update verification status. Do not silently overwrite prior published results or alter unrelated sessions.

5 Automated recovery and service exceptions

Routine cases remain automated

EXC-01: Correct, partial, wrong, skipped and confirmed unsafe responses follow rules automatically. No first-50 mandatory human approval or review-all requirement is introduced. Quality monitoring must not delay valid outcomes.

EXC-02: Low AI confidence is a signal to validate or recover evidence, not proof of a wrong answer and not an automatic zero. Translation failure alone must not invalidate reliable original-language interpretation where the approved processing path supports it.

Recovery sequence

EXC-03: Classify provider/network failures, missing artifacts, uncertain interpretation and finalization failures. Use bounded, configurable attempts and timeouts. Retry transient failures idempotently; use reliable original-language processing or approved alternate routes where available. If necessary and feasible, request a neutral recapture of the same answer without supplying its content.

EXC-04: Engineering must document finite attempt limits and deadlines suitable for the existing providers. These are engineering parameters, not unlimited retries or newly invented assessment thresholds. A failed background job must remain durably retryable or become a visible terminal incident; it must not disappear because an error was swallowed.

EXC-05: If reliable determination remains impossible, show the correct incomplete/evidence status and next action. Do not fabricate evidence or publish an unsupported Ready result. Merely omitting uncertain questions must not inflate a final percentage.

Administrator service intervention

EXC-06: Open a blocking service exception only when unresolved platform capture, interpretation, processing or delivery issues materially prevent a reliable applicable outcome. Create an incident with assessment/account, cause, affected output, owner, deadline, next action and audit trail. Notify the administrator in-system and by email, and prevent duplicate notification storms.

EXC-07: The administrator repairs service delivery or verifies recoverable evidence. The engine determines readiness. Keep valid unaffected outputs accessible. A dispute may trigger a non-blocking audited evidence check; disagreement alone does not suspend a valid result or confer a credit remedy.

Assessment points

CRD-01: For a verified unrecoverable platform-side failure preventing completion or delivery of a valid assessment, restore the exact actual deducted assessment points to the same account. Release an unconfirmed reservation instead where appropriate; never both release and restore the same deduction.

CRD-02: No remedy solely for voluntary withdrawal, skips, abandonment, poor performance, Not Ready, certificate ineligibility or disagreement. A recoverable interruption producing a valid result does not qualify. Distinguish platform/provider faults from candidate device/network interruption; do not assume all interruptions are platform failures.

CRD-03: One remedy per incident; no restored points plus free replacement for the same incident. Subsequent independent platform failures are separate. Use transactional, idempotent adjustments linked to the original debit and record reason, amount, account, assessment, incident, time and authorization. Points restoration is not a cash refund. Finalization must not create duplicate charges or leaked reservations.

6 Engineering closure and acceptance

Targeted corrections from the supplied evidence

FIX-01: Reconcile source rubrics, importer and runtime. HK-SAF-001 permits 3 for its stated partial case; HK-PRO-001 retains its legacy 2-point condition. Confirm the precise applicable safety classifications rather than suppressing all omissions or weakening safety globally.

FIX-02: Investigate HK-TSK-002's negative positive-evidence weight and zero-weight indicators elsewhere. For HK-TSK-001, reconcile 3 of 6 steps, the approved completion mapping, and the reported 5/10 versus executed 6/10 before mandatory zero. Do not certify a report whose arithmetic does not match its trace.

FIX-03: Check the same importer/scoring patterns across the consolidated bank. Identify generic answers or conflicting score notes that materially prevent fair scoring and resolve affected specifications. This is targeted reconciliation, not an instruction to recreate all questions.

FIX-04: Reconcile actual selected question IDs with role/tier coverage. Do not reopen historical coverage claims without evidence from the active configuration. Keep evidence of corrections and version activation.

Acceptance cases

Case	Required result
Full and partial answers	Exact approved band, including allowed partial credit; no blanket mandatory zero.
Legacy and completion questions	Correct exceptional maximum, score and denominator; executable source mapping.
Negated versus affirmed unsafe action	Different evidence classification; approved automatic gate consequence only for supported evidence.
Confirmed skip versus lost response	Skip retains denominator and approved zero; platform loss recovers or shows insufficient evidence without a final inflated percentage.
Boundary values	Test immediately below, exactly at and above 40 and 60 before rounding, with independent gate tests.
Employer scorecard	Evidence-linked ratings, visible coverage gaps, final lock, no background AI overwrite and correct path labels.
Languages and modalities	Real-provider EN/AR plus representative other supported languages; voice and typed translation both directions, original/translation provenance.
Recovery and points	Exhausted retries create a visible incident and notifications; exact once-only remedy; no refund for failure or withdrawal.
Documents and corrections	Automatic valid outputs, separate certificate gate, correct report claims, versioned corrections and verification status.

QA-01: Test full journeys with real providers as well as controlled fixtures. Expected outcomes must come from executable approved rules, not copied current behavior. The prior 22/22 checks alone are not acceptance evidence. Exercise the actual database, background jobs, document delivery and notification integrations.

REL-01: Engineering owns implementation, regression testing and controlled release under the existing process. Keep version pinning, a verified backup and rollback. Return one consolidated completion record with implemented rules, tests, versions and any remaining precise exceptions. Escalate only unresolved policy conflicts; do not insert a new blanket pre-Production management review step.

REL-02: Three details are not supplied as final numeric specifications in the discussion: undefined question rubrics, fixed employer-level point mappings, and unresolved indicator severity/mandatory effects. Do not label these approved or guess values. Resolve the affected configuration once with the methodology owner; proceed independently with all fully defined corrections.

Reference basis: management discussion through 20 October 2026; MeritLense Candidate Assessment Rules dated 19 October; the two supplied scoring comparison and simulation documents. This rulebook states implementation direction and does not represent external accreditation or completed specialist validation.